

are integrated with quizzes. The MOOC focus is the student—"I think I have understood, but have I?" Each brief tutorial is followed by a quiz to help you gauge if you have understood the concept just discussed. Currently, the handling of quizzes may involve just questions and answers. There are many tools that will let you create a quiz dynamically from a pool of questions. A good one is from the Khan Academy, github.com/Khan/khan-exercises.

However, smarter quiz and evaluation bots will emerge. For example, Hewlett Foundation sponsored a prize to improve the automated scoring of student essays. To be useful, the quizzes have to adapt themselves to the individual being tested—an obvious use of AI techniques. No wonder the breakthrough MOOC was a course on artificial intelligence and involved Peter Norvig, co-author of 'AI: A Modern Approach'. You may enjoy the concise six-minute video of his experiences on ted.com.

Integrating it all

Google has a project called Course Builder to help you create a MOOC as an App Engine application. It is a good resource for the steps and the ideas that may need to be considered. Stanford has created a platform called Class2Go, github.com/Stanford-Online/class2go. With the variety of tools available, it would be easy for you to roll your own framework, quite possibly, by using Drupal or a similar CMS as the base. You don't even need to wait for someone to create a MOOC to learn. One great opportunity for learning a new subject would be to create a MOOC by re-mixing existing content and sharing it with the world :). 

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Product	Features
App.net	Static custom pages for apps Download via SMS and email Better social sharing
AppHero	Good social recommendation Personalised app recommendation
Crosswalk	Social recommendation Personalised app recommendation Good app search
BuzzDoes	Social and personal recommendation Gives incentives to the users Developer needs to integrate their SDK

Test Drive feature is available only for apps hosted on the Amazon app store, and only in the United States; and usable only in Web browsers with Flash support. Moreover, they lack social features, as it is region-specific.

In spite of all these products in the market, app discovery still remains an unsolved mystery. While concluding, I would love to mention that we at AppSurfer try to overcome these limitations. We are trying to combine the remedies to the app discovery issue, so as to make the Android application ecosystem more mature

and complete. We run Android applications in the browser, so users can try apps before they download them. We have social recommendations in place, as well as widgets that make your Android applications run on blogs, on Web pages and in the Facebook feed itself.

All in all, app discovery is a well-known problem, but I feel that if tackled rightly, it is solvable! 

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